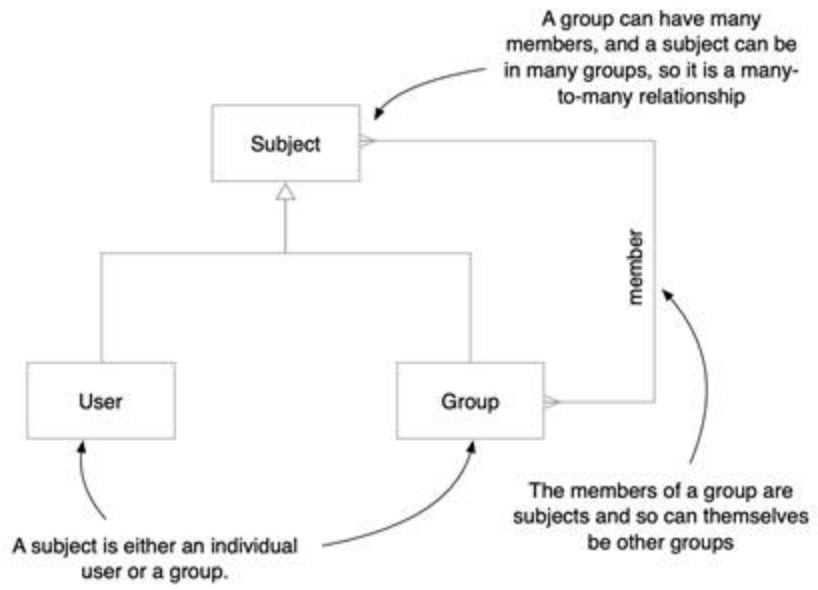


Figure 8.1 Groups are added as a new type of subject. Permissions can then be assigned to individual users or to groups. A user can be a member of many groups and each group can have many members.

The advantage of groups is that you can now assign permissions to groups and be sure that all members of that group have consistent permissions. When a new software engineer joins your organization, you can simply add them to the “software engineers” group rather than having to remember all the individual permissions that they need to get their job done. And when they change jobs, you simply remove them from that group and add them to a new one.

UNIX groups

Another advantage of groups is that they can be used to compress the permissions associated with an object in some cases. For